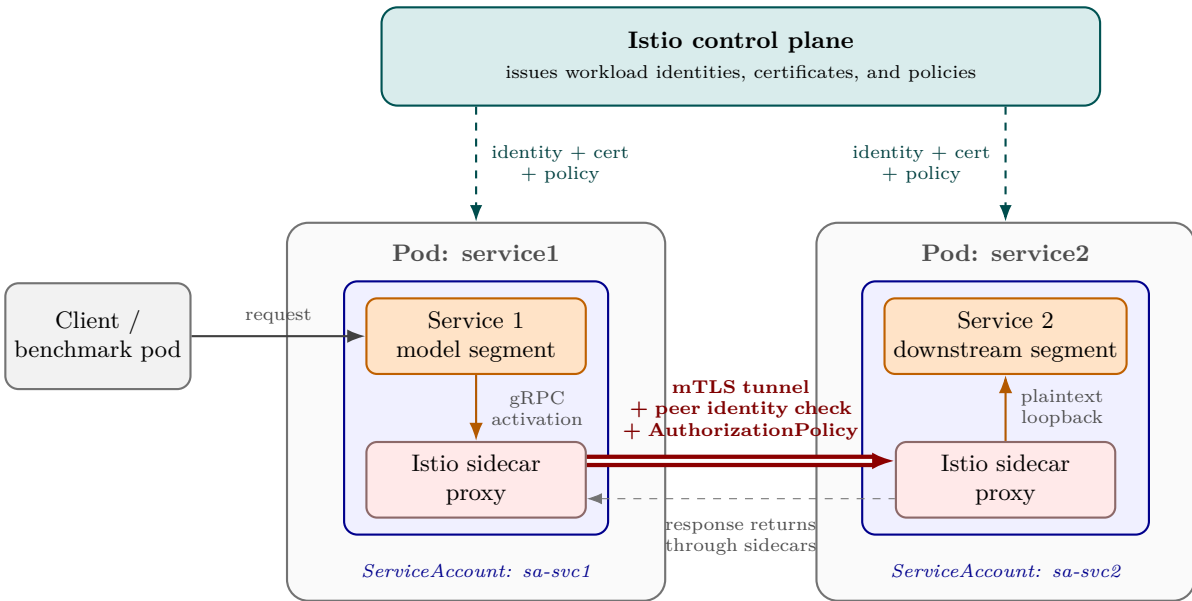




mTLS protects the service-to-service path. After sidecar termination, activations are plaintext inside the receiving pod.

Stage H1: Request flow with Istio mTLS, service identity, and authorization policy.